

REPORT CLASSIFICATION

Classification Type	Full Form Analysis
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DATE / TIME

Date of Occurrence	2004-10
Local Time Of Day	1201-1800

PLACE

Locale Reference	Airport
Locale	ZZZ.Airport
State	US
Altitude - AGL	0

AIRCRAFT / EQUIPMENT X

Aircraft Operator	Air Carrier
Make Model Name	B737-300
Crew Size	2
Operating Under FAR Part	Part 121
Flight Plan	IFR
Mission	Passenger
Flight Phase	Parked
Maintenance Status - Maintenance Items Involved	Repair

COMPONENT 1

Aircraft Reference	X
Aircraft Component	Leading Edge Slat

PERSON 1

Location Of Person	Company
Reporter Organization	Air Carrier
Function - Maintenance	Technician
Qualification - Maintenance	Airframe
Qualification - Maintenance	Powerplant

Experience - Maintenance Technician	35 yrs
Experience - Maintenance Lead Technician	2 yrs
ASRS Report Number	636850
Human Factors	Time Pressure
Callback	Completed

PERSON 2

Reporter Organization	Government
Function	Other: Inspector

PERSON 3

Location Of Person	Company
Reporter Organization	Air Carrier
Function - Maintenance	Technician
Qualification - Maintenance	Airframe
Qualification - Maintenance	Powerplant
Experience - Maintenance Technician	20 yrs
ASRS Report Number	636380
Callback	Completed

EVENTS

Anomaly	Aircraft Equipment Problem - Critical
Anomaly	Deviation / Discrepancy - Procedural - Maintenance
Anomaly	Deviation / Discrepancy - Procedural - Published Material / Policy
Detector - Person	Other Person
Result - General	Maintenance Action
Result - General	None Reported / Taken

ASSESSMENTS

Contributing Factors / Situations	Aircraft
Contributing Factors / Situations	Chart Or Publication
Contributing Factors / Situations	Company Policy
Contributing Factors / Situations	Human Factors
Contributing Factors / Situations	Logbook Entry

NARRATIVE 1

ON MAR/WED/04 I INSPECTED WORK ON THE CARD. THE CARD INDICATED THERE WERE 3 CRACKS ON SLAT AFT EDGE. THE 3 CRACKS WERE STOP-DRILLED AND NDT WAS ACCOMPLISHED. I VERIFIED THE STOP-DRILLED CRACKS PER MANUAL REF. THE MANUAL REF WAS IN THE CORRECT AREA FOR A SLAT REPAIR. A TURNOVER ON THE WRITE-UP BY THE PRODUCTION SUPVR INDICATED THAT HE PROGRAMMED THE SLAT FOR FUTURE REPAIR AND FOR REPEATED INSPECTIONS AS PER THE MANUAL. ON OCT/WED/04 (FAR RAMP INSPECTION), DISCOVERED THAT ACFT ABC, A B737-300, OPERATED IN REVENUE SVC WITH A TEMPORARY REPAIR TO THE #3 SLAT OUTER LOWER SKIN. THIS IS NOT AUTHORIZED BY THE BOEING SRM. THIS REPAIR TO THE SLAT HAS BEEN PREVIOUSLY ACCOMPLISHED AND ENDORSED BY THE ENGINEERING DEPT AT THIS ACR. SUPPLEMENTAL INFO FROM ACN 636380: I WAS NOTIFIED RECENTLY BY OUR ACR QUALITY ASSURANCE THAT AN FAA INSPECTOR FOUND A DISCREPANCY RELATED TO A SIGNOFF I MADE ON A #3 SLAT ON ACFT ABC. I'VE APCHED OUR ENGINEERING DEPT ABOUT THIS REPAIR SEVERAL TIMES AND HAVE GOTTEN SEVERAL DIFFERENT ANSWERS. MY STOP-DRILLING OF THESE CRACKS WAS DONE WITH THE KNOWLEDGE OF SRM AND ENGINEERING ON THAT DATE. CALLBACK CONVERSATION WITH RPTR ACN 636850 REVEALED THE FOLLOWING INFO: THE RPTR DESCRIBED THE REPAIR ON THE SLAT ACCOMPLISHED PER THE SRM. THE SRM REFERS TO THE LOWER RIVET LINE ON THE #3 SLAT FOR REPAIR OF CRACKS COMING FROM THE RIVET HOLE TO THE SLAT EDGE. THE REPAIR WAS TO DRILL OUT THE RIVET AND STOP-DRILL THE CRACK AND INSTALL ANOTHER RIVET. THE RPTR STATES THE SHOP MISSED THE LIMITS ON THIS REPAIR THAT IT IS NOT PERMITTED 5.5 INCHES FROM EITHER END OF THE SLAT AND 6 INCHES INBOARD AND OUTBOARD OF THE ACTUATOR ROD END CONNECTION. THIS IS PRECISELY WHERE THE REPAIRS WERE ACCOMPLISHED. CALLBACK CONVERSATION WITH RPTR ACN 636380 REVEALED THE FOLLOWING INFO: THE RPTR SAID THE REPAIR WAS A COMMON SHOP PRACTICE BELIEVED TO BE ACCOMPLISHED PER THE SRM AND VERBALLY APPROVED BY ENGINEERING. THE REPAIR OF THE LOWER SLAT RIVET CRACKS WERE REPAIRED BY DRILLING OUT THE RIVET AND STOP-DRILLING THE CRACK THEN REPLACING THE RIVET. THE SRM LIMITS OF THE REPAIR WERE NOT KNOWN TO THE RPTR AS EVERYTHING WAS VERBAL INSTRUCTIONS AND NOTHING IN WRITING. THE RPTR SAID A READING OF THE SRM WOULD HAVE PREVENTED THE IMPROPER REPAIR.

SYNOPSIS

A B737-300 #3 SLAT REPAIR WAS DISCOVERED BY AN FAA SAFETY INSPECTOR TO BE IN CONFLICT WITH THE SRM LIMITS.

